constituted oxygen audit committee which was headed by AIIMS Chief Dr Randeep Guleria. The report found that,

> There were significant errors made by the hospitals in the data that they were reporting. Initial summing up of oxygen consumption claimed by the hospitals (1140 MT) was about 3–4 times higher than what was the expected consumption (289–391 MT) using formulae for the established bed capacity for these hospitals. It was noted that some hospitals had claimed extremely high oxygen consumption with very few beds, while others had shown high negative consumption values that could not be justified. The claims appeared to be erroneous, leading to extremely skewed information and adjustment for both extremes resulted in more realistic values. It was thus recognised that there was a problem with the quality of data being generated for calculating oxygen requirement and capacity building was needed to gather correct data.[76]

The Delhi government had shown that the actual consumption reported by hospitals was 1,140 MT per day. However, after 'correction' of the error, the oxygen requirement fell to 209 MT. The report further noted that hogging of more oxygen than needed during a national fight, where many other states were also in need of oxygen led to their supply getting affected.[77] When the report emerged, Kejriwal tweeted in Hindi, 'My fault was that I fought for the breath of 2 crore people. When you were [Prime Minister Narendra Modi] busy campaigning for election, I was burning the midnight oil to arrange oxygen. People have lost their relatives due to oxygen shortage. Please don't lie, they are feeling bad.'[78] He left out the part mentioning that shortages were made to appear due to lack of efforts, planning on part of his government and black marketing!

What kind of a government-hospital-black market syndicate was being run to create a fake alarm of oxygen shortage, demand much more than required by getting hospitals to grossly overestimate need and make the excess disappear into the black market so that there would still be shortages?

While this episode played out for months in the media, Indians were paralysed with shock that such politicking would play out at the cost of their lives. Who would take responsibility for deaths which occurred in